



CHINESE STUDIES GLOBAL WEBINAR - FALL 2026

CENTER FOR CHINESE STUDIES, UNIVERSITY OF HAWAI'I AT MĀNOA

FREE
to public

An established bilingual international online forum for dialogue, discovery, and connection in Chinese Studies



OCT. 7
WEDNESDAY
12:00 PM -1:30 PM HST



STUDENT RESEARCH PROJECT

Making Modern China in Hawai'i:

Chinese Diaspora, Citizen Diplomacy, and Pan-Pacific Internationalism, 1910s–1920s

In the early twentieth century, American civic leaders promoted Hawai'i as a center of Pacific cooperation and a model of interracial harmony while sidelining Native Hawaiians. Drawing on Chinese-, Hawaiian-, and English-language sources, Bohan Zhang examines how Chinese communities in Hawai'i and visiting Chinese scholarly diplomats appropriated the forums of the Pan-Pacific Union and the Institute of Pacific Relations to pursue their own goals. Following Honolulu-born Ho Kim Tong and the delegates with whom he interacted, the talk moves from an All-Chinese baseball team's 1915 tour of China to a 1920 U.S. congressional visit and the Pan-Pacific conferences of the 1920s. It shows how athletes, community hosts, and scholarly delegates practiced citizen diplomacy through sport, hospitality, and conferences to present China as a modern nation and assert its place in the Pacific. The talk closes by considering why faith in Honolulu-centered internationalism waned in the early 1930s.

SPEAKER

BOHAN ZHANG



Bohan Zhang is a Ph.D. candidate of Rice University in history specializing in the United States in the Pacific world, Hawai'i, and modern China. His dissertation examines the trans-Pacific endeavors of migrants, intellectuals, diplomats, and athletes in shaping Pan-Pacific internationalism in twentieth-century Hawai'i. His peer-reviewed article received the 2026 Louis Pelzer Memorial Award from the Organization of American Historians and is forthcoming in the Journal of American History.

DISCUSSANT

TARCISIUS KABUTAUAKA



Tarcisius Kabutaulaka is an Associate Professor in the Department of Pacific Islands Studies at the University of Hawai'i at Mānoa. He is a scholar of Pacific politics and international relations, with research interests spanning geopolitics, China-Pacific relations, Pacific regionalism, natural resources and economic development, and land tenure systems.

SHANA BROWN



Shana J. Brown is Director of the University Honors Program and Associate Professor of History at the University of Hawai'i at Mānoa. Dr. Brown is a historian of science and culture in Asia, particularly modern China. Her research and teaching bring the sciences and humanities in conversation, foregrounding the contributions of Asian intellectuals, especially women, to modern science and academic life. Her book *Pastimes* (Xiāoqiǎn) was recently published in Chinese by Zhejiang University Press.

MODERATOR



BAOYAN CHENG

Professor & Graduate Chair,
Educational Foundations,
College of Education,
University of Hawai'i at Mānoa

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